

A TEPID RESPONSE

The PMIS had hoped to provide 10 million internships to young graduates in top 500 companies in five years. But the results of the two rounds of the pilot have been disappointing

	Round 1 (Oct. 3-Dec. 2024)	Round 2 (Jan. 9-Apr. 2025)
Candidates who registered at PMIS	181,000	214,000
Number of companies that participated	280	327
Internship opportunities they posted	127,000	118,000*
Applications sent by candidates	621,000	455,000
Internship offers made	82,000	83,000 (as of Nov. 26)
Candidates who accepted	28,000	24,600 (as of Nov. 26)
Candidates who finally joined	8,700	7,300
Candidates who left midway	4,565 (as of Nov. 26)	2,053 (as of Nov. 26)

Source: Parliament questions; *New and unfilled opportunities of previous round

OUTLAY FOR PMIS

₹2,000 crore FY25 allocation for PMIS

₹840 crore Allocation for the pilot

₹380 crore Revised estimate for pilot

Illustration by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

to Rs 380 crore, of which only Rs 73.72 crore has been utilised so far.

The disappointing first round prompted the government to launch a second one this January, with no improvement in uptake. As a result, there is no clarity yet on when the scheme will be formally launched. As a senior official explains, "After we evaluate the outcome of this pilot, we will decide if we will do another one or announce the scheme. All we can say right now is we learnt a lot from this pilot, which will help us fine-tune the main scheme when it is launched."

If there is one encouraging aspect across the two rounds, it's the industry response. To get companies on board, the MCA worked through industry bodies like FICCI and CII, who in turn engaged with member companies for implementation, resolving queries and collating data. Prominent companies such as Tata Steel, Maruti, ONGC, Reliance, Eicher Motors signed up.

In the first round, 280 companies posted 127,000 opportunities, 2,000 more than the requirement of 125,000. The vacancies attracted 621,000 applications from 181,000 candidates registered on the PMIS portal. But, eventually, the companies could make only 82,000 internship offers, which meant a third of the opportunities went abegging. Worse, only 28,000, or just 34 per cent, of the candidates accepted the offers and, finally, only 8,700, or a third, joined. Of these, 4,565, or nearly half, left midway.

The second round followed a similar trajectory. While the participant companies rose to 327, the 118,000 internship opportunities—new and old—were fewer than the previous round. Companies made 83,000 internship offers, of which 24,600 were accepted, and only 7,300 joined. Of these, 2,053 have already quit without completing the internships. As of November, a mere 95 interns have been offered full-time jobs across 17 companies in the two rounds.